Almaz Isakov

Lead Product Designer based in Almaty, Kazakhstan — Open to remote, hybrid and relocation (EMEA)

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Product design leader with 10+ years of experience designing and scaling products across e-Commerce, e-Grocery, Fintech and B2B. My design expertise and experience building creative teams and design practices enable me to drive impact at every level: from hands-on execution and mentoring designers to shaping product direction and scaling design operations

EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer

Halyk Market
Almaty, Kazakhstan

Jun 2024 - Present

Kazakhstan's #5 e-Commerce in Kazakhstan (Forbes 2026), part of the super-app of Halyk Bank, the country's largest bank by assets (8M+ MAU). I lead design across Storefront, e-Grocery and B2B. Built and manage a team of 4 designers, owning design processes, quality and the design system.

Design leadership:

- Rebuilt the design team and established the design practice: hiring, roles and ownership per product stream
- Achieved 1.5x faster Time-To-Market by introducing a shared design system and review process (Design QA, regular syncs); features now pass design review in a single round
- Introduced an AI-assisted asset workflow, delivering 120+ category images for the new e-Grocery vertical in under a month
- Led the team through post-purchase redesigns that increased CES (Customer Effort Score) by up to +10 pp (percentage points)

Hands-on product design:

- Redesigned Checkout into a single-page flow: +4.6 pp purchase conversion, -20% completion time (A/B test, ~1.6M users)
- Redesigned the product page → seller selection journey: +6.5% conversion
- Designed the e-Grocery MVP from scratch

Lead Product Designer

360.tech
Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Aug 2022 - Feb 2024

DOSCREDOBANK's IT lab driving bank's digital transformation. Led a team of 4 product designers across multiple marketplace streams (customer, internal tools & B2B), owning quality, delivery, and collaboration with PM and engineering stakeholders

- 90% on-time delivery rate achieved through end-to-end planning and execution of webview experience overhaul for the marketplace
- 2x faster Time-To-Market by standardizing core design rituals (documentation, reviews, Design QA, and regular syncs), which improved delivery predictability and cut rework
- Mentored designers through regular 1:1s and critique sessions, raising the overall bar for interaction and visual design quality and promoting consistent patterns across product streams

Senior Product Designer

360.tech
Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Jul 2021 - Aug 2022

Led design for internal (offer & order management) and B2B systems supporting the marketplace ecosystem:

- Designed and launched Seller Cabinet MVP which got over 50% of sellers approval for MVP workflow adoption
- ~80% Task Success rate on main workflows (offer listing, product creation application)

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer

DOSCREDOBANK
Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Aug 2020 - Jul 2021

Top 5 bank of Kyrgyzstan in Customer Experience Index (2023). Led design for internal tools (product information management) and foundational systems powering the bank's marketplace and web ecosystem:

- Designed and launched Product Information Management System (Admin Panel MVP)
- 3x faster content operations (product creation)
- 90% Task Success rate on main workflows (product creation, attributes and catalog management)

Co-Founder, Multidisciplinary Designer

Art Collective C
Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Feb 2015 - Aug 2020

Independent art collective producing multimedia projects (editorial and digital longreads, art works, exhibitions, documentary photo & video). Led visual identity and multi-channel communication design for an independent art collective, shaping how projects were presented across digital, editorial, and exhibition formats:

- Curated the country's first multimedia exhibition by Kyrgyz artists – a year-long show that attracted over 1,000+ visitors per day throughout its run
- Created site-specific installation "Emergency Exit" during an art residency in Chișinău, Moldova

Graphic Designer

Mozgami Studio
Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Aug 2015 - Dec 2018

Mozgami – Kyrgyzstan's top-ranked design studio specializing in brand identity and communication design. Designed visual identities, advertising campaigns, infographics, and print collateral for clients across FMCG, automotive, finance, and nonprofit sectors

- Launched and managed UX/UI as a new service at the studio, increasing project revenue and expanding the studio's offering
- Ideated and co-produced the "Balaty" project, which won a Gold award (Craft: Illustration & 3D category) at the Jolbors International Festival of Creativity, earning significant recognition for the studio

EDUCATION

Jusup Balasagyn Kyrgyz National University

Specialist in Risk Management, Business Economics (5-year, equivalent to Master's) · 2012, Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

LANGUAGES

Russian – native; English – B2

SKILLS

Product design, UX/UI design, Agentic AI Development, Spec Driven Development, Human Centered Design, JTBD, Design Systems, Design Operations, Design management, Stakeholder management, Design strategy, System thinking, Prompt Engineering, User research, Usability testing, Art directing, Prototyping

HONORS & AWARDS

Gold in Craft: Illustration & 3D at Jolbors - International Festival of Creativity

Balaty – a social project of printed and Telegram sticker packs, with free sets distributed openly and paid ones raising funds for orphanages · 2016, Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

TOOLS

Figma, Figma Weave; Claude Code; Paseo.sh; Model Context Protocols; Recraft; JIRA, Confluence; Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign; Affinity